



A SCULPTURE survives at a home razed by the Hawk fire in Reno, a boomtown at the wildland-urban edge. JOSH EDELSON AFP/Getty Images

Pushing urban, wildland limits in Reno

The Hawk fire shows the risks that come with moving farther into nature areas.

By HAILEY BRANSON-POTTS

Over the last 15 years, the population of Reno — the so-called Biggest Little City in the World — has surged, thanks in large part to an influx of Californians drawn by Nevada’s cheaper housing, booming tech industry and relative lack of soul-crushing traffic.

From 2010 to 2025, Reno’s population grew an astonishing 26%, to more than 283,000 people.

With all that growth, new development has expanded farther and farther into the fire-prone scrubland surrounding the Sierra Nevada foothills city just across the California border.

This week, a massive fire posed a threat to these new boomtowns.

The Hawk fire forced the harried evacuation of more than 40,000 people. It ignited near a hiking trail in the parched hills just northwest of the city on Saturday. “It basically started in a residential neighborhood,” said Chris Buckley, a spokeswoman for the unified incident command fighting the blaze.

“There are so many more people moving into these areas because they’re so desirable,” said Buckley, who works for the U.S. Forest Service. “Who doesn’t want to move to a beautiful, wild area and have all the conveniences of the city? But it really strains the wildland-urban interface.”

Reno is discovering what California has long known: Sprawling development into fire-prone areas can put those new communities at risk.

The wildland-urban interface — where human development intermingles with wild places such as scrublands, grasslands and forests — is the fastest-growing land-use type in the United States.

And the Hawk fire is the latest example of the growing threat of destructive urban conflagrations in these zones as the planet warms, [See Reno, A7]

\$12.5 billion for Lakers might be a good deal

Some analysts say price tag is too high, but investment could ultimately pay off.

By STEVE HENSON

Joshua Kushner and Bob Iger, successful businessmen by any measure, paid \$12.5 billion for the Lakers, easily the highest price ever for a sports franchise.

It was a rare chance to acquire an celebrated sports brand, and by all accounts, timing was everything.

The enormous sale price has implications for the rest of the NBA and raises a basic question: Did Kushner and

Iger get a great deal or did they overpay?

Business titan Mark Walter owned the NBA franchise for only a year. Federal regulators are investigating Walter’s financial empire, and he reportedly felt compelled to sell as he moves billions to help unravel undisclosed related-party loans from two of his insurance companies to multinational holding company TWG Global — an abbreviation for The Walter Group, at which he serves as chief executive.

Before many learned that Walter might be interested in selling the team quickly, Kushner and Iger, already pining for an NBA franchise, jumped at the opportunity.

The haste of the trans-

action would seem to have given the buyers superior leverage, yet Walter negotiated a 25% increase on the \$10 billion he spent on the team in October.

Some experts argue that the Lakers are worth every penny. A deep dive into the market for legacy sports franchises indicates to Sports Value Consulting co-founder and Chief Executive Michael Rapkoch that the investment is sound.

“How often do the Lakers come up for sale? Why wouldn’t someone pay that amount if they were able?” Rapkoch said. “Are you going to be the person who says at a cocktail party that you could have bought the team [See Lakers, A13]

DOLLY PARTON, 1946 – 2026



TERRY WYATT Getty Images

STAR POWER

She mixed homespun charm, glam looks and serious songwriting chops.

All-American music icon

The entertainer became a national treasure who was loved for her talents and empathy

By RJ SMITH

Dolly Parton, the singer and songwriter from Locust Ridge, Tenn., who willed herself into being the very symbol of country music stardom, has died in Nashville.

Parton died peacefully Tuesday, her nephew Bryan Seaver announced in a press release shared with The Times. Seaver also announced her death in a video shared to the singer’s Instagram page. She was 80.

The fabled entertainer died after a series of health issues that led her to postpone several performing commitments. In September 2025, she missed the an-

nouncement of a Dollywood attraction to recover from a kidney stone. Later that month she delayed her residency at Caesars Palace — her first residency on the Las Vegas Strip in more than 30 years — due to unspecified “health challenges.”

Over the course of a flamboyant 50-plus-year career as a songwriter, recording artist, actor and businesswoman, Parton reinvented the American success story through a combination of grit and wit, faith and sex appeal, virtuosity and plainspokenness, empathy for the human condition, and plastic surgery.

She seized on the roles that American culture allowed [See Parton, A8]

ESSENTIAL SONGS: “Jolene,” “9 to 5” and more hits. ENTERTAINMENT, E1

Canada planning tariffs as high as 50% against U.S.

The duties might be most painful for border states heading into the midterms.

By MICHAEL WILNER

WASHINGTON — Canada retaliated against the United States in an intensifying trade war Tuesday by announcing steep new tariffs on roughly \$20 billion worth of American goods at the core of the U.S. economy, a sharp escalation between the neighboring allies after trade negotiations between them abruptly collapsed.

The new duties will hit a variety of American products with tariffs as high as 50%, including steel, dairy products, appliances and farm equipment, and will target items on routine shopping lists, like seafood, cheese, clothing, cosmetics and toilet paper.

Ottawa’s moves come after President Trump announced 50% tariffs on Canadian goods, warning Canada to “fall in line” in trade

negotiations that Canada’s prime minister, Mark Carney, characterized as an attempt to subjugate his country.

“We did not choose this conflict, but when our economic integration is used as a weapon rather than the foundation for a win-win partnership, we need to stand up,” Finance Minister Francois-Philippe Champagne said in a statement announcing the new measures.

The White House, in a statement, said that Canada “has been ripping off the United States for decades,” and that Trump “is done letting them get away with it.” And the president has threatened to escalate even further by targeting Canadian vehicles, auto parts and [See Canada, A4]

State wineries brace for impact

Boycotts on American alcohol in some provinces had already devastated vineyards. BUSINESS, A11

Is this worst time to buy in SoCal?

It may feel like it, but home prices aren’t up as much as expected, Times review finds.

By TERRY CASTLEMAN

Home seekers around Southern California were feeling profound sticker shock.

Median prices had hit records never seen before.

First-time buyers were desperately slapping downpayments on modest ranch homes in far-flung desert communities, enduring long commutes just to escape the rental market.

“We were lucky,” said one new homeowner who bought a place in Tehachapi, 100 miles from her workplace in Chatsworth. “I don’t know if we’d still be able to afford it.”

Welcome to the crazy housing market of 2026? No, try 2005.

It’s easy to look at today’s steep median home prices — \$885,000 in L.A. County and \$1.19 million in Orange

County, per Zillow — and say it’s never been worse.

But California has long dealt with cycles of soaring prices that lock out people with modest incomes. The last supercharged market in the early 2000s was fueled in part by ultra-liberal mortgages and lending that eventually sparked the global housing crisis and recession, including a wave of foreclosures.

Reforms have made lending more stringent, and along with rising prices, have altered the demographic of the California homebuyer over two decades.

A new analysis from The Times shows that the median homebuyer in the region has changed significantly since 2005.

Among the findings:

■ The types of people who can afford homes has changed. Homebuyers today can afford more, but they are older and wealthier than they were in 2005. Meanwhile, housing is even more out of reach for those in lower-income brackets.

[See Homebuying, A12]

Schools fear loss of subsidized internet

FCC may end or scale back E-Rate program, which helps districts save on broadband.

By LINDA JACOBSON

As superintendent of Desert Sands Unified in the Coachella Valley, Kelly May-Vollmar has a hard time naming a system that’s not somehow connected to the district’s broadband network.

Parents can check a school bus tracking app to make sure their child arrived on time. Cafeteria staff don’t use cash registers — kids’ meal accounts are linked to the cloud. Even grounds crews depend on external wireless access points to maintain the fields and landscaping at the district’s 34 schools.

“They’re running our sprinkler systems off iPads,” May-Vollmar said.

Her district is one of more than 96,000 across the country that apply each year for discounts on broadband

service through a federal program called E-Rate. High-poverty districts like Desert Sands save up to 90% of the cost of connecting their schools and classrooms to the internet.

But the Federal Communications Commission, which oversees the program Congress created 30 years ago, has launched a “top-to-bottom” evaluation that has leaders of the nation’s school districts on edge. The FCC is collecting views on how the program should be reformed, or even whether it should be abandoned because it “has fulfilled” its mission.

In addition to asking whether the benefit should be restricted to rural districts, the agency links E-Rate to present-day concerns over screen time. Comments are due Oct. 13 and replies are due Nov. 12.

The proposal is “aimed at empowering parents and ensuring that our E-Rate program produces the great educational outcomes stakeholders have in tended,” FCC Chairman [See E-Rate, A7]

Firm to pay O.C. leak evacuees

Up to \$100 million will be disbursed to claimants affected by the chemical disaster. CALIFORNIA, B1

Their friendship comes full circle

Freeman and Heyward share a 20-year baseball and life journey that reunites them again on Dodgers. SPORTS, B10

Uber lets parents track child’s ride

New feature, in which the driver enables video, launches in nine markets but not California yet. BUSINESS, A11

Weather Hot. L.A. Basin: 96/75. B6

